

1 FAMILY



Family isn't about whose blood you have. It's about who you care about.

Trey Parker & Matt Stone

All married couples should learn the art of battle as they should learn the art of making love. Good battle is objective and honest – never vicious or cruel. Good battle is healthy and constructive, and brings to a marriage the principle of equal partnership.

Ann Landers

□ VOCABULARY INPUT

Dealing with this topic you will come across the following vocabulary. Read it and look up the unknown words in your dictionary.

- **some family members/relatives/distant relatives:** siblings, parents, grandparents, great-grandparents, parents-in-law, godparents, step-parents, foster parents, first/second/distant cousin, nephew, niece, daughter-in-law, son-in-law, aunt, uncle
- **family status:** single, engaged, married, divorced, widower, widow, single parent, the/an only child, middle child, the oldest child, orphan, adopted child, twins
- **family structure:** nuclear family, extended family, step family, single parent family
- **roles of family and family members:** biological, economical, educative, emotional, protective, sociological, supportive
- **duties and responsibilities:** *cleaning in the house:* mop the floor with the mop, sweep the floor with the broom, vacuum the carpet with the vacuum cleaner (hoover), polish with a cloth, dust with a cloth, take out the rubbish, wash with a damp cloth, wash up (the dishes), hang the clothes on the washing line, iron, make beds, *working in the garden:* sow seeds, plant flowers/bushes/trees, water the plants, weed the flowerbeds, cut the grass/mow the lawn, *other activities:* doing the shopping, picking up children from school, cooking, walking the dog, feeding pets, fixing broken things
- **family celebrations and gatherings:** birthdays, christening, confirmation, graduation, job promotion, wedding, feast, funeral
- **describing family members:**
appearance: attractive, beautiful, handsome, good-looking, tall(ish), short(ish), little, skinny, thin, well-built, large, plump, chubby, neat
human traits/qualities: positive: friendly, reliable, responsible, decent, modest, fun, mature, generous, gentle, open-minded, faithful, trustworthy, sympathetic, with good sense of humour, extraordinary, jealous, sincere, honest *negative:* mean, malicious, selfish, rude, impolite, aggressive, offensive, greedy, reluctant, annoying, hysterical, disobedient, stubborn, cheeky
- **life cycle:** to be born, to make friends, to date sb., to get on with sb., to fall in love, to propose, to get engaged, to live together/to cohabit, to marry sb./to get married to sb., to settle down, to set up a family, to become pregnant, to expect a child, to deliver a baby, to raise children/to bring up children, to get divorced, to be separated/to break up (with), to grow old, to die/to pass away
- **weddings:** fiancé, fiancée, engaged couple, engagement ring, wedding ceremony, wedding reception, town hall (mayor), church (priest), bride, groom, spouse, best man, bridesmaid, maid of honour, wedding dress (wedding gown), tuxedo, bouquet, confetti, honeymoon
- **problems in families:** lack of trust, money matters, generation gap, living with grandparents, career, poor family relationship, gambling, addiction to alcohol/drugs, unemployment, early pregnancy, physical and mental abuse

□ DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

Before reading the text, discuss the following questions in class.

1. How would you define the word "family"?
2. What does family mean to you?
3. What makes a happy functional family?
4. When do you, as a family, meet up?
5. What is your opinion of living together without marriage?
6. What are the main reasons for divorce?
7. What makes a marriage last?
8. What is better – to have liberal or over-caring parents?
9. Describe your own family.
10. Explain the proverb "In time of test, family is best".

□ TEXT

Read the texts below in silence. Check the meaning of the words in bold and answer the questions below.

TYPES OF FAMILIES AND THEIR FUNCTIONS

A **nuclear family** consists of a mother, father and children who **share** certain **goals** and **values** and live together in one home. Besides nuclear families, there are **extended** families that also include grandparents. A family is the most important social unit that **provides** protection, education, social interaction, **care for** the aged, sick or **disabled**. It also supplies basic physical, economic and emotional security for its members. Therefore, it **fulfils** a biological, sociological, emotional, economic and educational **need** in modern society. In a functioning family a strong relationship can be observed between its members. Human needs such as love, protection, responsibility and **support** are fulfilled there. Families get together for various **occasions** and anniversaries, such as birthdays, **graduation**, weddings, **christening** and **confirmation** parties, religious celebrations and **funerals**. A family, a real home and relatives are what we need for life. One automatically becomes a family member immediately after being born. However, there are some **exceptions**. **Orphans** and **abandoned** children grow up in **orphanages** and **foster homes**, where they get love from non-biological parents and **siblings**. Adopting a child is a very long process.

1. What is meant by the terms 'nuclear' and 'extended' families?
2. What are the functions of a family?

ROLES OF FAMILY MEMBERS

The main role of parents is to **raise** their children. Parents should teach their children how to **differentiate** between right and wrong, how to solve problems in life, become an independent person and **care about** others. Democratic parents **lead a dialogue** with their children and respect their opinions. **Authoritative** parents set strict rules without attempting to find compromises. Such an **approach** often leads to a **generation gap** between parents and their own children. Very **liberal** parents give too much freedom to their children without limits. **Overcaring** parents give too much love and usually bring up **spoilt** and dependent children who are unable to **set up** their own **families**. Care for **the aged**, our grandparents and **great-grandparents**, is either divided up among family members or supported by social workers in **old people's homes**.

3. What are the main roles of parents in a family?
4. Talk about different types of parents described in the text.

DUTIES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

All family members have specific social roles with various **duties** and **responsibilities**. **Domestic chores**, such as cooking, shopping and cleaning, should not be **assigned** only to women. In modern countries, boys are normally expected to help from childhood. Modern women are quite ambitious. They require more than just some help with little chores, such as cutting the grass, cleaning the car or taking out the **rubbish**. Nowadays, we can see more and more fathers **pushing prams** or playing with their children in parks. Furthermore, there are some men who decide to stay at home with their babies on "**maternity**" leave instead of their wives who may have better-paid jobs. Being in a partnership also means many duties and responsibilities connected with **bringing up** children.

5. Which domestic chores are mentioned in the text?
6. How do the social roles of men and women change with regard to family duties and responsibilities?

SINGLE OR MARRIED?

Family is the product of historical development. Modern European families are monogamous and married couples are expected to be **faithful** to each other. The **average** age for marriage is much higher than it was in the past. Statistics show that the **majority** of young people get married in their late twenties or early thirties. There is no **prejudice** against women and men who do not get married before a certain age. In the past, they were labelled as **spinsters** and **bachelors**. Nowadays, they are **recognised** as modern people who either live with somebody in the same **dwelling** or as people who do not want to be **tied down** by marriage. Living together without being formally married is called **cohabitation**. It is still **dubious** to the older generation and totally unacceptable **among** Catholics. Some

couples get married only when babies **appear**. When **the engaged** decide to get married, a **fiancé proposes** to his **fiancée**. In some families, this act is **accompanied** by a family celebration and a ritual in which the potential **son-in-law** offers a **bouquet** to his potential **mother-in-law** and asks the fiancée's father for **permission** to marry his daughter. The wedding is a formal act that takes place in a **town hall** or in a church, where the **engaged** couple exchange their wedding rings and promise to live together in good and bad times and in illness too. **Despite** this promise, it is often broken and the couple **gets divorced**.

7. What is cohabitation?

8. What happens after a man and a woman decide to get married?

BROKEN FAMILIES

Research shows that in Britain, one in three marriages ends in divorce. American sources say that every second couple **gets divorced**. **Common** causes for this are differing interests, lack of trust, financial problems, living with parents and parents-in-law, **addiction** to alcohol, drugs or **gambling** and unemployment. **Broken families** in our country are not different. Currently, teenagers have better **access** to sex education and **contraception** than in the past which prevents marriages and divorces at an early age. In the case of divorce or the death of one of the parents, children are brought up by a **single parent**. A woman who loses her husband is called a **widow** and a man is a **widower**. When they get married again, the new parents are called **step-parents**. The situation gets very serious when a child is separated from his loving mother, father or **sibling**. In some cases, divorced parents get married to each other once again.

9. What are common causes of divorce?

10. Who are single parents and step-parents?

□ VOCABULARY LIST

abandoned – opustený
access (to) [ækses] – prístup (k)
to accompany – sprevádzať
addiction (to) [ə'dɪkʃn] – závislosť na
among – medzi (viac ako dvomi)
to appear – objaviť sa, prísť
approach (to) – postoj (k)
to assign – prideliť, priradiť
authoritative [ɔ:θɒrətətɪv] – autoritatívny
average – priemerný
bachelor [bætʃlə(r)] – starý mládenec
bouquet [bu'keɪ] – kytica
to bring up – vychovať
broken family – neúplná rodina
to care about – záležať na
to care for – starať sa o
cohabitation – spolužitie
common – bežný
confirmation – birmovka
contraception [kɒntrə'sepʃn] – antikoncepcia
christening [krisnɪŋ] – krst
despite – napriek
to differentiate [dɪfə'renʃieɪt] – rozlišovať
domestic chores [tɒ:ʃs] – domáce práce
dubious [dju:biəs] – pochybný
duty – povinnosť
dwelling – obydlie, príbytok
exception – výnimka
extended family – širšia rodina
faithful – verný
foster home – náhradný domov
to fulfil – spĺňať
funeral – pohreb
gambling – hazardné hry
generation gap – generačný rozdiel
goal – cieľ
graduation – promócia
great-grandparents – prastarí rodičia
liberal – liberálny
majority [mə'dʒɒrətɪ] – väčšina
maternity leave – materská dovolenka
mother-in-law – svokra

nuclear family – najbližšia rodina
occasion [ə'keɪʒn] – príležitosť
old people's home – domov dôchodcov
orphan [ɔ:fən] – sirota
orphanage [ɔ:fənɪdʒ] – sirotinec, detský domov
overcaring – príliš sa starajúci
permission – povolenie
prejudice [prədʒudɪs] – predsudok
to provide [prə'vaɪd] – poskytnúť
to raise [reɪz] – vychovať
to recognise – (AmE: recognize) – uznať
to require [rɪ'kwaɪə] – vyžadovať
research – výskum
responsibility – zodpovednosť
rubbish – odpadky, smeti
share – zdieľať, mať spoločné
sibling – súrodenec
single parent – rodič, ktorý sám vychováva dieťa
son-in-law – zať
spinster – stará dievka
spoilt – rozmazaný
support – opora, pomoc
step-parent – nevlastný rodič
the aged – starí
the disabled – postihnutí
the engaged [ɪŋgeɪdʒd] – zasnúbení
town hall – radnica, mestský úrad
value – hodnota
widow – vdova
widower – vdovec

a fiancé proposes to a fiancée – snúbenec požiada snúbenicu o ruku
to be tied down – byť viazaný, obmedzovaný
to get divorced – rozviesť sa
to lead a dialogue – viesť rozhovor
to push a pram – tlačiť detský kočík
to set up one's own family – založiť si vlastnú rodinu

□ VOCABULARY PRACTICE

Task 1 Fill in the box to make male and female pairs.



Male	Female
<i>Example:</i> boyfriend	<i>girlfriend</i>
1.	wife
son-in-law	2.
3.	sister-in-law
cousin	4.
5.	godmother
grandfather	6.
7.	great-granddaughter
nephew	8.
9.	aunt
widower	10.
11.	fiancée
father-in-law	12.
13.	ex-wife
groom	14.
15.	bridesmaid
bachelor	16.

Task 2 The following words/expressions are used to describe the appearance of people.



a) Can you put them into the following categories?

OVERALL APPEARANCE: _____

WEIGHT: _____

HEIGHT: _____

AGE: _____

FACE: _____

EYES: _____

HAIR: _____

CLOTHES: _____

SKIN: _____

skinny – tall – teenager – well-built – slim – baby – elderly person – neat – in his/her early fifties – bun – plump – attractive – wearing glasses – round – beard – wrinkled – spiky – sun-tanned – hazel – curly – ponytail – handsome – pale – straight – dark – casual – freckles – deep set – highlights – dyed – old-fashioned – moustache – trendy – toddler – frail – wavy – wide open – chubby – balding – shabby – little – middle-aged – scruffy – fair – in his/her late forties – shoulder-length – smallish – auburn

b) Describe the most interesting person in your family using the words in the box above.

Task 3 Jason has a big family. Explain his relationship with his relatives following this family tree.

